

Praise of the Uncommon Qualities Abiding in the Dharmakāya

Dharmakāyaguṇāsādhārāṇastava · Toh 1115 · Derge Tengyur

ཆསོ་གཏུ་ལྷ་གནས་པའི་ཡོན་ཏན་ཐུ་མངོ་མ་ཡན་པ་ལ་བསྐྱོ་པ།

Toh 1115 in the Tengyur is a devotional hymn known in Tibetan as Chökyi ku la né pa'i yönten thünmong ma yin pa la töpa, which may be rendered into English as "Praise of the Uncommon Qualities Abiding in the Dharmakāya." The text is a stotra, a genre of laudatory verse composed in honor of the Buddha, and it celebrates the extraordinary and unshared qualities that reside in the Dharmakāya, the ultimate body of a Tathāgata — qualities such as boundless compassion, omniscient wisdom, and perpetual meditative equipoise. Each verse offers a reverential bow to a distinct aspect of Buddhahood, combining doctrinal precision with devotional fervor in the manner characteristic of Indian Buddhist hymnic literature. The text was translated into Tibetan by Gyalwai Zangpo and the Śākya monk Nyima Gyaltsen Palzangpo, and it is preserved among the praise and stotra literature of the Tengyur.

Translated by Gyalwai Zangpo and the Śākya monk Nyima Gyaltsen Palzangpo.

Praise of the Uncommon Qualities Abiding in the Dharmakāya

I bow to all the Tathāgatas.

You who hold compassion for all sentient beings,
who contemplate their meeting and separation,
who abide in contemplating their inseparability with bliss —
to you, that contemplation, I bow.

Utterly freed from every obscuration,
the Sage who overwhelms every world,
your knowledge pervades all that is to be known —
to you, mind liberated, I bow.

You who tame without remainder
every affliction of every sentient being,
who yourself are afflicted by the affliction of love —
to you, full of tenderness, I bow.

Spontaneously accomplished, free of attachment,
free of obstruction, always
remaining in meditative equipoise, answering
every question — to you I bow.

In explaining places and those who abide in them,
words and the knowledge being taught,
your intelligence is never obstructed —
to you, supreme Teacher, I bow.

Knowing the words and conduct of those
who come making requests,
you guide beings who wander or who have renounced —
to you, skilled guide, I bow.

When all those with bodies behold you
they come to understand you as the supreme person,
and by the mere act of seeing you they come to faith —
to you, thus acting, I bow.

Over receiving, abiding, and releasing,
over emanation and transformation,
over meditative absorption and primordial wisdom,
you hold mastery — to you I bow.

Through means, refuge, and purity,
through definite emergence into the Great Vehicle,
you who vanquish the māra that deceives
all sentient beings — to you I bow.

Displaying wisdom, abandonment,
and the obstacles to definite emergence,
none other — neither tīrthikas nor any being —
can match you for the good of self and other — to you I bow.

You who speak decisively to your assembly,
who have utterly and forever abandoned all affliction,
who need no protection, who forget nothing,
who gather the congregation — to you I bow.

Whether departed or remaining, it is always so —
omniscience is not something you merely perform;
you are truly and genuinely omniscient —

to you, omniscient one, I bow.

You who accomplish the welfare of all sentient beings,
never transgressing the bounds of what time can bring,
always bringing results to pass,
you who forget nothing — to you I bow.

Over the entire world, beneath a single parasol,
you cast your gaze six times in a day,
you who are endowed with great compassion,
intent on benefit — to you I bow.

By your departure, your inner realization,
your knowledge, and your enlightened activity,
you surpass all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas —
to you, supreme of all, I bow.

Having attained through the three bodies
every aspect of the great awakening,
you always resolve the doubts
of every sentient being — to you I bow.

Free of wavering, free of fault,
free of turbidity, free of remaining,
free of agitation, and with regard to all phenomena
free of conceptual elaboration — to you I bow.

By this praise I have offered of the qualities abiding in the dharmakāya,
may I and all wandering beings swiftly realize
the one endowed with six qualities, the three bodies perfectly complete.

Translator's Notes

- The stanza "ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय" presents a deliberate paradox: the Buddha, who dispels afflictions in others, is himself "afflicted" by compassion. The rendering "afflicted by the affliction of love" preserves this intentional rhetorical inversion, which is a recognized trope in Indian stotra literature.

The line "ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय" is somewhat compressed and may mean: omniscience is not a performance or a quality the Buddha merely enacts situationally, but is his genuine, constant nature whether he has passed beyond or remains present. The translation reflects this reading.

The final prose dedication breaks off mid-phrase in the source text, ending with "ॐ नमो" — the passage is incomplete as supplied. The translation renders what is present.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.